ARSHDEEP SINGH, 25 >

Fast Bowler

T20s: 52, WICKETS: 79
ECONOMY: 8.39



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When India needed a pacer to share the new ball with Jasprit Bumrah in this T20 World Cup, they went in with the young left-armer Arshdeep over a more experienced Mohammed Siraj. Interestingly, this was Arshdeep's second ICC trophy with Rahul Dravid as coach. Back in 2018, the Punjab colt was part of the Indian team that won the Under-19 World Cup under Dravid's tutelage. So, the coach knew exactly what he was capable of. Arshdeep finished the tournament as the joint highest wicket-taker (17) and provided his team those crucial early breakthroughs. The journey may have just started for him, but even with a bowler of Bumrah's calibre operating from the other end, Arshdeep has managed to make his presence felt. It's all thanks to his ability to move the ball both ways.



AFP

< ABHISHEK SHARMA, 23

All-rounder

IPL MATCHES: 104, RUNS: 2,671
SR: 153.59; WICKETS: 32, ECON: 7.11

Not many can hit the ball as long and as clean as Abhishek Sharma. Mentored by Yuvraj Singh, Abhishek's bravado with the bat yearned for an amphitheatre, and the previous season of the IPL, where he opened with Australian Travis Head for Sunrisers Hyderabad, turned out to be the stage he needed. He matched Head stroke for stroke and his strike rate of over 200 meant he was Team India–ready. Not surprisingly, he has got his maiden India call-up for the tour of Zimbabwe. Like Yuvraj, Abhishek is also a handy left-arm spinner. Hopefully, the Punjab boy will achieve success like his idol.

AFP



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^ RINKU SINGH, 26

Batsman

T20s: 15, RUNS: 356, SR: 176.24

When India's T20 World Cup squad was announced in April-end, Rinku Singh's non-selection became a talking point. After all, he had done enough in the last one year to merit a spot in the India XI. Those five consecutive sixes in an IPL game in 2023 meant the Internet was no longer flooded with stories of his struggle while growing up; his cricket took the centrestage and he did get into the Indian team before the T20 World Cup. While he missed the bus for the Caribbean, he is certain to be a regular in this Indian team. In 11 T20I innings, he has scored 356 runs at an average of 89 and a strike rate of over 176. The best part about his knocks was that he was unbeaten in seven of those 11 innings, finishing the task at hand.

v YASHASVI JAISWAL, 22

Batsman

T20s: 17, RUNS: 502, SR: 161.93

Arriving in Mumbai as a 10-year-old with no money or shelter, armed only with oodles of talent, Yashasvi's determination propelled him through myriad challenges. From the maidans of Mumbai to the 2020 Under-19 World Cup, where he emerged as the leading run-scorer, his ascent has been meteoric. His fearless batting in domestic circuits caught selectors' eyes, earning him the call-up across all formats for Team India...and he didn't disappoint. Though the young southpaw watched India's recent T20 World Cup success from the dugout, his time has undoubtedly arrived. With Rohit and Virat stepping back from T20Is, the stage is set for this prodigy to lead India's batting charge.



AFP